
TYPOGRAPHY

DOC NO. RL-BRAND-001-TYPE-A REV. A RIPOSTE LABORATORIES

CONTENTS

▶ 1 • One family	2
When the real font is unavailable	3
▶ 2 • The two registers	3
The document – UPPERCASE, tracked	3
The builder – sentence case, 400/700	4
▶ 3 • The scale	4
▶ 4 • The tracking ladder	6
▶ 5 • Rules of use	7
▶ 6 • The wordmark lockup	7
▶ 7 • Glyphs, not icons	8
▶ 8 • Numbers, units and placeholders	8
▶ 9 • Setting type in tools that aren't a browser	9

SEC.01

1 • ONE FAMILY

JetBrains Mono. Weights 400, 700, 800. That is the entire type system.

Designer	JetBrains / Philipp Nurullin, Konstantin Bulenkov
Licence	SIL Open Font License 1.1 – free to use, embed, redistribute and bundle, including commercially
Download	jetbrains.com/lp/mono • Google Fonts
Self-host	assets/fonts/*.woff2 in this repo (latin, latin-ext, vietnamese subsets)

CSS

```
--font-mono: "JetBrains Mono", "IBM Plex Mono", ui-monospace, SFMono-Regular, Menlo, Consolas, "Liberation Mono", monospace;
```

There is no second family. Not for headings, not for prose, not for "a bit of contrast". Hierarchy comes from four levers – size, weight, case, tracking – and those four are enough. A humanist sans dropped into a Riposte layout to "warm up the body copy" destroys the premise: this is a document produced by a machine shop.

Why a mono for prose? Because the brand is a spec sheet. The even rhythm of a monospace is the texture of instrument faceplates, terminal output and dimensioned drawings. It reads slightly slower than a proportional face, which is why the measure caps at 66ch and the body sits at a generous 1.55 line-height – the system compensates rather than compromising.

WHEN THE REAL FONT IS UNAVAILABLE

Upload it. Canva Pro, Figma, Adobe Fonts (as a custom font), Google Workspace via add-on, and every OS font book all accept an OFL font. The licence explicitly permits it.

Only if you genuinely cannot:

TOOL	FALLBACK	NOTES
Canva (free tier)	Space Mono	Closest in flavour; heavier quirk. Then Roboto Mono.
Google Docs/Slides	Roboto Mono	Available natively; the safest cross-platform fallback
Word / PowerPoint	Consolas	Ships with Office on every platform
Anywhere	IBM Plex Mono	The best overall substitute if installable

Record it when you do. A deck set in Roboto Mono is off-brand-but-legible; a deck set in Arial is neither.

SEC.02

2 • THE TWO REGISTERS

One voice, two registers. Everything on a Riposte surface is one of these.

THE DOCUMENT — UPPERCASE, TRACKED

Chrome and labels. Filed like a spec sheet.

DOC NO. RL-200-A

SEC.03

REV. A

SPEC / HEX UNIT

EST. 2026

Uppercase, 700 or 800, positive tracking that widens as the size drops. This register never carries a sentence — it carries an identifier.

THE BUILDER – SENTENCE CASE, 400/700

Prose. Plainspoken, concrete, quietly witty. Numbers that matter are bold.

A disposable vape is, functionally, a lithium cell wrapped in plastic and marketed as trash. Each holds a **14.46 Wh** cell measuring **45 × 13 mm**.

Section heads carry a lowercase slash-tag comment, right-aligned: `// the counter-attack, // local loop injection molding`. This is the one place the two registers touch – an uppercase heading with a lowercase code comment trailing it.

SEC.03

3 • THE SCALE

TOKEN	SIZE	WEIGHT	CASE	TRACK- ING	LEAD- ING	USE
--text-display	clamp(30px, 6.6vw, 74px)	800	UPPER	-.01em	1.02	Slide and hero statements
-text-h1	clamp(30px, 5vw, 54px)	700	UPPER	.03em	1.15	Page heads
-text-h2	clamp(24px, 3.2vw, 40px)	700	UPPER	.03em	1.15	Section headings
-text-h3	clamp(20px, 2.6vw, 30px)	700	UPPER	.03em	1.15	Sub-sections
-text-lead	clamp(16px, 2vw, 19px)	700	sen- tence	0	1.55	Lead paragraphs
-text-body	15px (16px homepage)	400	sen- tence	0	1.55	Prose
-text-md	14px	400	sen- tence	0	1.55	Spec body, secondary prose
-text-nav	12px	700	UPPER	.08em	—	Nav, SEC.NN chips, tags
-text-label	11px	700	UPPER	.1em	—	Kickers, spec headers, corner marks
-text-xs	10px	700	UPPER	.12em	—	Chip micro-labels

Every heading step is a `clamp()`. Do not add font-size media queries — the type already scales continuously between the min and max. If a heading is wrong at some viewport, adjust the `vw` coefficient, not the breakpoint.

SEC.04

4 • THE TRACKING LADDER

The governing principle: **tracking widens as type gets smaller and more "machine."**
Big statements tighten; micro-labels spread out until they read as engraving.

-.01em	display	big statements pull together
.03em	h1 / h2 / h3	uppercase headings need a hair of air
.08em	nav	links, buttons
.10em	label	chips, doc numbers
.14em	tag	// slash tags, corner marks
.16em	spec	spec-card headers, stamps
.30em	kicker	pagehead kickers
.55em	wordmark	L A B O R A T O R I E S I N C .

Uppercase monospace at 10-12px is genuinely hard to read without tracking – the letterforms are already even-width, so without extra space they fuse into a bar. The ladder is functional, not decorative.

Never track lowercase prose. Tracking applies only to the uppercase register. Body copy sits at 0.

SEC.05

5 • RULES OF USE

1. **Headings and labels are UPPERCASE.** Prose is sentence case. No title case anywhere in the system. Ever.
2. **Bold the numbers that matter.** In prose, load-bearing figures and units go 700: 14.46 Wh, 45 × 13 mm, 72%. This is the builder register's one flourish.
3. **Body copy maxes at 66ch.** Leads pull tighter, to 56-62ch.
4. **Leads are bold.** -text-lead is 700 by default. A lead paragraph set at 400 reads as body copy that happens to be bigger.
5. **800 is reserved.** Deck headlines and .stat numbers only. If everything is 800, nothing is.
6. **No italics.** Monospace italics are weak and the system has no use for them. For emphasis inside prose use 700, or .hi (which is 700 + -accent-text).
7. **No underlines except on links.** And links get 2px thickness at 3px offset – a hairline underline disappears against the mono texture.
8. **Line-height is 1.55 for prose, 1.15 for headings, 1.02 for display.** Tight display leading is what makes a two-line hero statement read as a single block.

SEC.06

6 • THE WORDMARK LOCKUP

The letterspaced sub-line beneath the mark:

| L A B O R A T O R I E S I N C .

- ▶ Tracking .55em (--tracking-wordmark)
- ▶ Uppercase, weight 400 – **not** bold; the mark above carries the weight
- ▶ Optically centred under the wordmark. Because .55em adds trailing space after the final character, subtract roughly half the tracking value from the right side or it will sit visibly left-of-centre.
- ▶ Size: about 1/8 the height of the wordmark's cap height

Full logo rules: 04-logo.md_{RL-BRAND-001-LOGO.}

SEC.07

7 • GLYPHS, NOT ICONS

The system has **no icon font and no icon set**. Meaning is carried by characters that JetBrains Mono already contains:

- list bullets (accent-coloured)
- ✓ pass / yes × fail / no ! warning
- flow, forward ↓ flow, stacked ▸ disclosure caret
- ◆ diamond marker (R) the loop (@) contact

No emoji beyond 🔄 and ✉, which are established site glyphs and render monochrome in this context. Everything else that looks like an icon is a **hand-built SVG line diagram** in brand colours — see 05-patterns.md_{RL-BRAND-001-PAT.}

SEC.08

8 • NUMBERS, UNITS AND PLACEHOLDERS

- Units get a space: 14.46 Wh, 45 × 13 mm, 230 V. Use × (U+00D7), not x.
- Ranges use an en dash with no spaces: 56–62ch, 400–800.
- Document control: DOC NO. RL-000-A, REV. A, SEC.03, EST. 2026.
- The ticker: PARRY • RIPOSTE • RECYCLE • REPEAT 🔄
- **Placeholders are honest and loud.** \$[TAM], [Q_/__], flagged ▲ Illustrative — replace before sending. A placeholder that looks like real data is a liability; make it impossible to ship by accident.

SEC.09 9 • SETTING TYPE IN TOOLS THAT AREN'T A BROWSER

Sizes here are CSS pixels. For fixed-size media:

CONTEXT	BODY	H2	NOTES
Web	15-16px	clamp(24px, 3.2vw, 40px)	As specified above
Slides (16:9, 1920×1080)	22-24px	54-64px	Display statements 90-120px
A4 / Letter print	9.5-10pt	18-22pt	See 08-print.md RL-BRAND-001-PRINT
Canva (1080×1080 social)	28px	64px	See ../tools/canva.md RL-BRAND-001-CANVA

The ratios hold even when the absolute sizes don't: display is ~4× body, h2 is ~2.5× body, labels are ~0.7× body.

SOURCE docs/02-typography.tex SHA a050bc1d6a09 BUILT 2026-09-07